

Daily Need to Know

Wednesday, 26 August 2026 · Pre-market brief

Coverage window, capture method and edition notes are at the back, in section 16.

1 Market snapshot — the close, and where it is trading now

Live rows captured 06:07:10–06:07:13 GMT+8 (2.6s window). Globex reopened 06:00 GMT+8 — futures rows carry the Tuesday Globex session, not the seven minutes since. ▲ up · ▼ down · ◆ flat/noise.

ASSET	LAST	CHANGE	NOTE
US CASH EQUITIES — SETTLED 04:00 GMT+8, ~2H 07M OLD			
S&P 500	7,677.28	▲ +24.42 (+0.32%)	Range 7,650.92–7,686.11; closed in the top quarter of it. 1.78% below the 7,816.70 record. Volume 2.376bn = 91% of the 10-day average.
Nasdaq Composite	26,151.30	▲ +171.11 (+0.66%)	Best of the four, and still the furthest from home: 3.82% below its 27,190 high. Volume 97% of average.
Dow Jones Industrial	53,577.40	▲ +160.24 (+0.30%)	Fourth straight advance. 2.13% off the 54,744 record.
Russell 2000	3,010.02	▲ +14.94 (+0.50%)	Closed 1.95 points off its session high — the cleanest close on the board. 1.94% below its record.
Philadelphia SOX	11,588.03	▲ +164.86 (+1.44%)	Bounced hardest, and it needed to: still 20.93% below its 14,655 high. Gave back 120 points from the intraday high into the close.
NYSE Composite	24,768.64	▲ +41.99 (+0.17%)	0.39% from an all-time high — the broadest US index is the closest to its record. This is the single most important number on the page.
US INDEX FUTURES — TUESDAY GLOBEX SESSION; GLOBEX REOPENED 06:00, ~7 MIN OF NEW TRADE, EFFECTIVELY NIL			
ES (E-mini S&P)	7,692.00	▲ +22.25 (+0.29%)	+14.7 over cash = +19bp basis, normal. Session range 7,660.25–7,714.00 on 961.6k lots (85% of average).
NQ (E-mini Nasdaq-100)	29,276.75	▲ +171.00 (+0.59%)	Range 29,017–29,425.75. Volume 480.9k = 98.5% of average, the busiest of the four relative to normal.
YM (E-mini Dow)	53,645	▲ +156 (+0.29%)	+67.6 over cash = +13bp basis. 52.4k lots.
RTY (E-mini Russell)	3,014.40	▲ +12.80 (+0.43%)	+4.4 over cash = +15bp basis. Volume 87% of average — small caps rallied on below-average participation.
US TREASURIES — CASH YIELDS, SETTLED WITH THE 05:00 GMT+8 BOND CLOSE			
US 10-year	4.623%	▼ –7.7bp	Closed at the session low of 4.619 after a 4.716 high. Below the floor of Hedgeye's own 4.63–4.74 band.
US 30-year	5.157%	▼ –7.0bp	Also closed at its low. 30s10s widened 0.7bp to 53.4bp.
US 5-year	4.332%	▼ –7.4bp	Biggest proportional move on the curve; the belly led the rally.
US 2-year	4.176%	▼ –6.2bp	Back below 4.20% — the level Hedgeye called bullish that same morning. 10s2s flattened 1.5bp to 44.7bp.
US 13-week bill	3.787%	▼ –1.1bp	Barely moved while the belly fell 7.4bp. 10y–3m holds at 83.6bp; the curve steepening is all long-end.
ENERGY — FRONT-MONTH FUTURES, TUESDAY SETTLES			
WTI crude	\$82.36	▼ –\$2.65 (–3.12%)	Range \$80.23–\$85.84 — a 6.6% intraday swing . Broke Hedgeye's TRADE (\$84) and TREND (\$83) in the same session.
Brent crude	\$88.58	▼ –\$3.59 (–3.90%)	Fell harder than WTI; the spread narrowed to \$6.22. One-week low.
Natural gas	\$2.770	▼ –\$0.012 (–0.43%)	Did not follow crude down. Sits at 68% of its risk range while crude sits at 32% — the two energy legs have decoupled.
RBOB gasoline	\$2.9297	▼ –\$0.0391 (–1.32%)	Fell only 42% as much as crude in percentage terms. Refining margin widened.
METALS — SPOT, LIVE; ROUGHLY ONE HOUR OF THE NEW FX SESSION, SO CHANGES ARE NOISE			
Gold (spot)	\$4,660.28	◆ +\$3.15 (+0.07%)	Six-dollar range since 05:00 — not a move. Futures settled \$4,694.50; the \$34.22 basis is normal contango. 16.8% below the 52-week high.
Silver (spot)	\$68.818	◆ +\$0.21 (+0.31%)	Spot sits \$0.14 above the futures settle — mild backwardation, a tightness signal. Still 43.4% below its 52-week high.

ASSET	LAST	CHANGE	NOTE
Copper (spot)	\$6.6711	◆ −\$0.002 (−0.03%)	Futures did the work: HG settled +1.65% at \$6.714, the best industrial metal on the day, 2.2% from a 52-week high.
CURRENCIES — LIVE, ~67 MINUTES INTO THE NEW SESSION; RANGES ARE TOO NARROW TO READ AS MOVES			
DX1	98.902	◆ −0.081 (−0.08%)	Range 98.863–99.118. Sits at 40.5% of Hedgeye's 98.31–99.77 band, signal bearish.
USD/JPY	159.217	◆ +0.017 (+0.01%)	A 3.8-pip range since the roll. That is an hour of nothing, not a stable yen.
USD/KRW	1,382.03	◆ −0.42 (−0.03%)	61-pip range — the widest of the majors, and the one Korea will actually trade off at 08:00.
VOLATILITY AND CRYPTO — CRYPTO IS THE ONLY GENUINELY 24-HOUR ROW HERE			
VIX	15.46	▼ −0.38 (−2.40%)	Range 15.13–16.30. Two points above its 13.38 52-week low, and 57% of the way up Hedgeye's band.
Bitcoin	\$78,748.71	▼ −\$231 (−0.29%)	Range \$77,853–\$81,233 — a real 4.3% swing overnight while everything else stood still. 37.6% below its 52-week high.

Reconciliation: cash index arithmetic ties exactly to Monday's published closes (S&P 7,652.86 · Dow 53,417.16 · Nasdaq 25,980.19). All three futures/cash bases land at +13 to +19bp — normal, and confirmation that the settled rows are settles and the futures rows are futures. Yahoo was rate-limited out of this run; see section 18.

TL;DR

Rank the US market by distance from its own record and the story writes itself: **Financials −0.16%, NYSE Composite −0.39%, Healthcare −0.74%, equal-weight S&P −0.75%, S&P 500 −1.78%, Russell −1.94%, Dow −2.13%, Nasdaq −3.82%, semiconductors −20.93%**. The index everybody quotes is a fifth of the way down that ladder. Tuesday's +1.4% bounce in the SOX changes none of it.

Crude did the day's real work. WTI fell **3.12% to \$82.36** on a \$5.61 intraday range as Washington swapped military threat for sanctions on Iran, breaking Hedgeye's TRADE and TREND lines in a single session and dragging the 10-year yield down **7.7bp to 4.623%** — through the floor of Hedgeye's own band. The 2-year fell back below the 4.20% level that Hedgeye had declared bullish six hours earlier.

Consumer confidence missed at **89.4 vs 90.1**, a seven-month low, entirely on Expectations (−5.8 to 68.2) while Present Situation rose 6.8 to 121.2. Nvidia reports tonight into \$91.9bn of consensus, an options market pricing event risk at a 10% implied-vol premium, and a share price wedged between a broken TRADE line at \$218 and an intact TREND line at \$208.

2 The big picture — what it means

- The broadening is now measurable in a single statistic, and it is not subtle.** The NYSE Composite — 2,000-odd names, every one of them equally able to embarrass a narrative — closed **0.39% from an all-time high**. The Nasdaq Composite closed 3.82% from its. Equal-weight S&P is 0.75% off its record while cap-weighted S&P is 1.78% off. In a genuinely narrow market that ordering is reversed. It is not reversed. The average stock is doing better than the index, and has been since July.
- Crude broke, and the bond market took the hint immediately.** WTI lost 3.12% because Washington signalled it would squeeze Iran financially rather than militarily — sanctions instead of strikes, which removes a supply-disruption premium rather than adding one. The 10-year fell 7.7bp to 4.623% and closed at the session low. That is the cleanest transmission mechanism in the market right now: oil is the marginal input into headline inflation, headline inflation is the marginal input into the long end, and both moved in the same session in the same direction for the same reason.
- Hedgeye's own 2-year call broke within hours of being made.** On Tuesday's Macro Show at 22:14 GMT+8, Keith McCullough said the 2-year yield had turned bullish TRADE and TREND on a move back above 4.20%, and that this made the Treasury steepener "less good". By the close the 2-year was **4.176%** — back below the line. This is worth stating plainly rather than quietly dropping: the inference that followed from the signal is only as durable as the signal, and the signal did not survive the session it was announced in.
- Tuesday was a mirror of Monday, which is what mean reversion looks like, not what a trend looks like.** Monday: Tech −1.8%, Staples +1.7%, Financials +1.3%, Micron −5.8%, Broadcom −2.6%. Tuesday: Tech +0.94%, Staples −1.06%, Micron +2.48%, Broadcom still −0.56%. AMD rose 4.91% and Western Digital 3.53%, but Sandisk fell 0.83% after a 6.7% intraday range and closed near its low, and Applied Materials opened at \$490 and closed at \$480. A sector that cannot hold its opening gap on a rally day is being sold into strength.
- The precious-metals drawdown is the position nobody is discussing.** Silver spot is **43.4% below** its 52-week high. Gold is 16.8% below its own. Yet silver spot trades \$0.14 *above* the futures settle — backwardation, which means physical tightness, not liquidation. Hedgeye added SLV to the long side of ETF Pro on Tuesday, buying into

the low end of the range. Buying a 43% drawdown that is simultaneously in backwardation is a coherent trade; buying it because it has fallen is not, and the distinction is the whole of the process.

6. **Credit is not confirming the equity rally, and that is the one crack worth watching.** High yield closed at 79.92, *above* the ceiling of its own risk range — fine. Investment grade closed at 106.86, also above its ceiling, but only **1.4% above its 52-week low** and 5.4% below its high. Long-duration investment-grade credit sitting near a one-year low while equities sit near records is a duration problem, not a credit problem — but it is a reminder that the 10-year at 4.62% is doing damage somewhere even on a day it rallied.
7. **Tonight is a referendum on the one thing this market has never repriced downward.** Nvidia is \$5.16 trillion, 9.9% below its high, and reports into consensus of \$91.9bn revenue and \$2.08 EPS against its own \$91.0bn $\pm 2\%$ guide. It has beaten four quarters running — by 5.65%, 6.58%, 4.00% and 2.97%, a visibly decaying sequence — and the stock has sold off after every one. Hedgeye holds no position, deliberately. When the largest company in the world is a coin flip, the correct exposure is often none.

3 Rates, currencies & commodities

- **The whole curve rallied but the front end lagged.** 5s -7.4bp , 10s -7.7bp , 30s -7.0bp , 2s -6.2bp , 3-month bills -1.1bp . Bills barely moved because they price policy, and nothing about Tuesday changed policy. 10s2s flattened 1.5bp to **44.7bp**; 30s10s steepened 0.7bp to 53.4bp.
- **Bond volatility fell with yields.** MOVE closed at **71.92**, down 2.78%, comfortably under the 75 threshold and less than a third of the way up its 55.77–115.02 twelve-month range. Falling rate vol alongside falling yields is a benign combination; the alarming version is yields falling while MOVE rises.
- **The dollar did nothing and the offshore yuan quietly did everything.** DXY is 98.902, mid-band, signal bearish. USD/CNH at **6.7162** is within a fraction of a pip of its 52-week low of 6.7156 — the renminbi is the strongest it has been against the dollar in a year, on the same day Beijing publicly rejected "illicit unilateral sanctions" over Iran. A currency appreciating into a trade confrontation is not the reflex the consensus expects.
- **Crude's break was structural, not a wobble.** Hedgeye's updated Alpha Code puts WTI TRADE at \$84 and TREND at \$83; the settle at \$82.36 is below both, and the risk range floor is \$80.13. From here the next reference is the floor, not the broken lines.
- **Food is the inflation that has not gone away.** Chicago wheat settled 703.25, up 0.54%, and sits within 1.6% of a 52-week high. Hedgeye flagged several food commodities up 10–20% over the past month. Cheaper crude and dearer food is not a disinflation; it is a rotation inside the basket, and the August CPI print in roughly two weeks is where the two get netted.
- **Copper is the quiet leader.** HG futures $+1.65\%$ to \$6.714, 2.2% from a 52-week high, while gold and silver sat still. Copper making highs while precious metals sit in deep drawdowns is a growth signal, not an inflation one.

4 Hedgeye — regime, risk ranges & the Quad path

DASHBOARD	READING	SOURCE & TIME (GMT+8)
Quad path	3 → 1 → 2 , explicitly restated; September is the #Quad1 month	Early Look, 25 Aug 19:59
S&P 500 regime	Investable Bucket; all-time highs "remain in play"; TRR ceiling 7,825	Early Look, 25 Aug 19:59
New TRADE/TREND breaks	WTI bullish → bearish (both levels). 2-year yield → bullish above 4.20% (<i>broke back below by the close</i>)	Macro Show, 25 Aug 22:14
Long equity book	RSP (equal weight), XLV (healthcare), IGV (software), JPM, small-cap value, HYG	Macro Show, 25 Aug 22:14
Short / avoid	USD, WTIC, XLU (only sector short), semis and DRAM (no position), South Korea (no position)	Macro Show + KM's Top 3
FX & commodity book	Short USD; long gold, EUR, JPY. Gold, silver and copper all still bullish TRADE and TREND	Macro Show, 25 Aug 22:14
Bitcoin	Shorts covered before the rally; no position ; waiting for a down day	Macro Show, 25 Aug 22:14
ETF Pro changes	ADD long OIH, SLV · ADD short EMIF, FBY, ZROZ · REMOVE long SMDV	ETF Pro Plus, 25 Aug 22:45
Signal Strength Stocks	85 names; added KDP, CRCL, TGT, DG, EVER; none removed	Signal Strength, 26 Aug 02:25

Risk Range™ Signals — Early Look, Keith McCullough, published 25 Aug 19:59 GMT+8

INSTRUMENT	RANGE	TREND	WHERE IT STANDS NOW, AND WHETHER THE BAND MOVED
UST 10-year yield	4.63–4.74	bullish	

INSTRUMENT	RANGE	TREND	WHERE IT STANDS NOW, AND WHETHER THE BAND MOVED
			4.623 — below the floor by 0.7bp. Band shifted down 2bp at the floor, 1bp at the ceiling vs Monday.
High Yield (HYG)	79.47-79.82	bullish	79.92 — 0.10 above the ceiling , 129% of band. Freshly bought by Hedgeye into Quad 1.
Inv. Grade (LQD)	105.4-106.6	bearish	106.86 — 0.26 above the ceiling on a bearish TREND. The two disagree; the TREND is the older signal.
S&P 500 (SPX)	7601-7825	bullish	7,677.28 = 34.1% of band . Band widened 17 points vs Monday's 7617-7824 — floor down 16, ceiling up 1.
Nasdaq Comp (COMPQ)	25806-26422	neutral	26,151.30 = 56.1%. The only US equity TREND that is not bullish.
Russell 2000 (RUT)	2975-3076	bullish	3,010.02 = 34.7%. Same low-in-band position as the S&P — small caps are not extended.
Healthcare (XLV)	168-178	bullish	175.29 = 72.9% , the most extended long in the book, and 0.74% from a 52-week high.
Equal Weight (RSP)	220.00-225.00	bullish	221.77 = 35.4%. Near a record and low in its band — the cleanest setup on the list.
Software (IGV)	100.00-106.00	bullish	Not captured this run; position in band unknown. Named as a core long on the Macro Show.
Shanghai (SSEC)	3837-3971	bearish	3,889.44 = 39.1% on a bearish TREND.
Nikkei 225 (NIKK)	64708-69201	bullish	65,856.36 = 25.6% — low in a very wide band. Returned to bullish TRADE and TREND.
German DAX	25883-26510	bullish	26,266.14 = 61.1%.
VIX	13.90-16.63	bearish	15.46 = 57.1%. Bearish TREND on vol is the bullish equity signal.
US Dollar (USD)	98.31-99.77	bearish	98.902 = 40.5%.
WTI crude (WTIC)	80.13-87.05	bearish	82.36 = 32.2% , and now below TRADE \$84 and TREND \$83. The freshest break in the book.
Natural gas (NATGAS)	2.64-2.83	bearish	2.770 = 68.4% — high in the band on a bearish signal, the opposite configuration to crude.
Gold spot (GOLD)	4340-4702	bullish	4,660.28 = 88.5% , near the ceiling. Band widened 24% vs Monday's 4403-4694 — floor down 63, ceiling up 8.

Band moves are measured against the ranges Keith McCullough published in KM's Top 3 Things on 24 Aug 18:30 GMT+8 (S&P, UST10Y, gold only). The Early Look category page does not paginate, so Monday's Early Look could not be reached directly and the remaining fourteen band moves are **UNKNOWN, not unchanged**. Metals measured on spot (TVC:GOLD), energy on the continuous contract (NYMEX:CL1!, NG1!), as Hedgeye names them.

What Keith actually said

From the Early Look, *Broadening Continues Into #Quad1*, 25 Aug 19:59 GMT+8:

- "Dusty dealt with pitch counts. We deal with Quad Counts. **Ours remains 3-1-2**. We're playing the #Quad1 tickers now."
- "The TRR for SPX's Risk Range™ Signal is still up at 7825. **All-time highs remain in play**."
- "NVDA traded down on over 135 MILLION shares yesterday and closed right at our TREND Signal Level of \$208... NVDA has a refreshed Risk Range™ Signal of \$192-230."
- "8 of 11 Sector Styles in the SP500 were up yesterday... 61% of stocks were up an average of +1.2% on the 'down day'."
- "Since we have chosen to have no Long/Short position in Semis for now, NVDA's earnings won't matter as much."
- "This Coach McCullough doesn't fall in love with the tickers that used to win for him. He coached whoever the Signal said was ready to play."

From KM's Top 3 Things, 24 Aug 18:30 GMT+8: "I personally have no position in either EWY or Semis (DRAM) heading into NVDA Wednesday (**choosing no position is a position!**)".

The Macro Show summary notes carry Hedgeye's own AI-generation caveat and are therefore reported here as attributed summary rather than quotation. On that basis: WTI broke bearish on both TRADE and TREND with an updated Alpha Code of 84/83; the 2-year turned bullish above 4.20%, which McCullough said makes the setup "less good for a steepening"; Nvidia's implied volatility moved from roughly a 7% discount to a 10% premium ahead of earnings; and a post-earnings recovery through \$218 was described as a conditional long setup toward \$230, not a position.

5 Mag7 scoreboard

NAME	LAST	DAY	CAP	READ
NVIDIA	213.05	▲ +2.19%	\$5.156tn	Reclaimed TREND \$208, still below broken TRADE \$218. 121.5m shares = 119% of average. \$213.94 after hours. Reports tonight.
Apple	309.90	▼ -0.14%	\$4.523tn	10.1% off its high. Did nothing in either direction, on either tape.
Alphabet	346.96	▼ -0.32%	\$4.224tn	15.1% off its high; closed near the session low. The quiet laggard of the group.
Microsoft	491.71	▲ +0.90%	\$3.651tn	Opened 485.44, closed 491.71 — held the whole gain. Best structural close in the seven.
Amazon	261.06	▼ -0.39%	\$2.816tn	Only 9.1% below its high, the least damaged of the group despite the down day.
Meta	570.05	▲ +1.97%	\$1.452tn	Best percentage gainer, and still 27.9% below its high — only 9.6% above its 52-week low. Gave 2.05 back after hours.
Tesla	350.25	▲ +0.37%	\$1.383tn	Ran to 357.00 intraday and closed at 350.25, near the low. 29.8% below its high.

Combined capitalisation **\$23.21 trillion**. Every one of the seven is below its 52-week high; two of them by roughly 30%. Capitalisations are TradingView's fundamental field captured at 06:07 GMT+8 and move with the last price.

6 Positioning & options

- **Event protection is being bid, and only in one name.** Nvidia's implied volatility went from roughly a 7% discount to a 10% premium ahead of tonight's print. VIX simultaneously fell 2.4% to 15.46. The index is not hedging; the single stock is.
- **Hedgeye's book moved down the quality curve into Quad 1.** High yield credit added, small-cap value emphasised, highly shorted equities named as the factor set. Adding HYG the same week it trades above its own range ceiling is chasing on the signal, and McCullough said as much: the bullish TREND has to come first, and factor characteristics alone are insufficient.
- **The new shorts are duration and single-name income.** ETF Pro added short ZROZ (zero-coupon long Treasuries) and FBY (Meta option income) alongside EM infrastructure. Shorting ZROZ on the day the 10-year fell 7.7bp is a position taken against the tape, which is what a range-high entry looks like.
- **Semis were bought on average volume, not on conviction.** AMD's 4.91% came on 18.94m shares against a 19.10m average; Micron's 2.48% on 19.05m against a 29.51m average — **65% of normal**. A 2.5% rally in Micron on two-thirds of typical volume is short covering, not accumulation.
- **Small caps rallied on light participation too.** RTY futures turned over 87% of average volume for a 0.43% gain. The Russell's close 1.95 points off its high was clean; the volume behind it was not.
- **What is not visible:** no Real-Time Alerts, MOMO Tracker or Crypto Quant appeared in the feed since the previous edition, so intraday position changes cannot be confirmed either way. See section 18.

7 Sector rotation — leaders & laggards

SPDR SECTOR	LAST	TUESDAY	FROM 52W HIGH	NOTE
Technology (XLK)	181.74	▲ +0.94%	-8.55%	Reversed Monday's -1.8% almost exactly. Slipped 0.06% after hours.
Communications (XLC)	113.18	▲ +0.77%	-6.00%	Meta did most of it. Closed at the session high.
Healthcare (XLV)	175.29	▲ +0.34%	-0.74%	+7.5% month to date and holding the league lead. Hedgeye's largest conviction long.
Utilities (XLU)	43.31	▲ +0.21%	-9.39%	Hedgeye's only sector short, down 3.6% in August. Weakest sector versus its own high bar Energy.
Financials (XLF)	58.31	▲ +0.15%	-0.16%	Effectively at a 52-week high. Bounced off the low end of its range on Monday and has not looked back.
Real Estate (XLRE)	45.36	▲ +0.07%	-2.36%	Should have led on a 7.7bp rally in tens. Did not. Rate sensitivity is not working.
Materials (XLB)	53.58	◆ 0.00%	-1.13%	Unchanged to the cent on an 8.18m-share day, then +0.39% after hours. Copper's strength did not reach it.
Discretionary (XLY)	117.95	▼ -0.30%	-5.65%	Fell on the day consumer confidence expectations dropped 5.8 points. Consistent.
Industrials (XLI)	178.40		-5.20%	

SPDR SECTOR	LAST	TUESDAY	FROM 52W HIGH	NOTE
		▼ -0.34%		Opened 180.76 and closed 178.40 — gave up the entire gap. Worst intraday reversal of the eleven.
Staples (XLP)	86.52	▼ -1.06%	-4.02%	Gave back most of Monday's +1.7%. The defensive bid was one day old.
Energy (XLE)	62.06	▼ -1.66%	-4.08%	Worst sector, and it fell only half as much as crude. 27.4m shares = 112% of average.

- **Leaders:** Technology, Communications, Healthcare. Two of those three were Monday's losers — that is reversal, not rotation.
- **Laggards:** Energy, Staples, Industrials. Energy's underperformance is explained by the crude break; Industrials giving up a 1.3% opening gap is not explained by anything.
- **The real rotation, on the month:** Healthcare +7.5% versus Utilities -3.6% is **1,100bp of spread in three weeks** — the largest single positional payoff in Hedgeye's sector book, and it came from being long the July Quad 4 short and short the July Quad 4 long.
- **The tell for today:** Financials and Healthcare are each within 0.8% of a record. If either breaks out while the Nasdaq stays 3.8% below its high, the broadening thesis stops being an argument and becomes an arithmetic fact.

8 Forward — futures & the week ahead

Globex reopened at exactly 06:00 GMT+8, seven minutes before capture, so the futures complex carries Tuesday's session and essentially no new information. ES settled the Globex day at **7,692** on 961.6k lots, 85% of average; NQ at **29,276.75** on 480.9k, the only contract to trade at a normal clip; YM at **53,645**; RTY at **3,014.40**. All four bases against cash sit between +13bp and +19bp, which is exactly where they should be. Overnight FX has run roughly 67 minutes with 3.8 pips of range in dollar-yen and 8 pips in euro-dollar — Asia opens into a market that has genuinely not moved since New York went home. The only instrument that traded meaningfully overnight is Bitcoin, which swung 4.3% between \$77,853 and \$81,233 and finished lower.

DAY (GMT+8)	KEY EVENTS
Wed 26 Aug	Building permits 20:00 · Q2 GDP second estimate 20:30, consensus 1.5% vs 2.1% prior · PCE price index 20:30 · durable goods orders 20:30 · EIA crude inventories 22:30 · Hedgeye geopolitics call 22:00. After the US close: NVIDIA fiscal Q2 2027 (cons. \$91.9bn rev, \$2.08 EPS, own guide \$91.0bn ±2%) and CrowdStrike .
Thu 27 Aug	Asia trades the Nvidia reaction from 08:00 — Tokyo, Seoul and Taipei price it before US futures find a level. Weekly US jobless claims 20:30.
Fri 28 Aug	Month-end. July PCE detail and the last positioning day of August; rebalancing flows into a market where equal-weight has beaten cap-weight all month.
Roughly 2 weeks	August CPI. Hedgeye expects the year-on-year rate to re-accelerate, which is the entire basis for its 2-year yield call and its scepticism of the steepener. This is the print that settles the argument.
September	The #Quad1 month on Hedgeye's 3-1-2 path — the regime the current long book is positioned for.

Earnings dates confirmed against company and exchange calendars. GDP consensus of 1.5% is from secondary calendar sources and should be treated as indicative rather than exact.

9 Corporate news

- **Intuit beat and fell anyway.** Fiscal Q4 adjusted EPS **\$4.03 vs \$3.58** consensus on revenue of **\$4.354bn vs \$4.27bn**. Shares dropped more than 7% after hours on fiscal 2027 revenue guidance of **9-10% growth against 14% delivered in fiscal 2026**. A four-point deceleration guided by management is worth more than a 45-cent beat, and the tape priced it that way within minutes.
- **Zoom reported after the bell** with AI Companion paid users up **184% year on year**. The number the market was waiting on was enterprise net dollar expansion crossing 100% for the first time; that figure was not confirmed in the sources reachable this morning.
- **Workday fell 2.38% to \$194.42** and slipped a further 0.70% after hours — 22.2% below its 52-week high, and the weakest large-cap software close of the session.
- **Intel opened at \$90.06, printed \$90.18, and closed at \$87.48** — up 0.25% on the day but 3.0% below its own high, on 81.4m shares. A near-perfect example of a stock being distributed into a rally.
- **Sandisk did not participate in the semiconductor bounce.** Down 0.83% to \$1,480.77 after a \$98 intraday range, closing near the low, and **37.1% below** its 52-week high. Western Digital, its closest comparable, rose 3.53%. The memory complex is no longer trading as one.
- **Oracle rose 1.62% to \$144.76** and remains **58.1% below** its 52-week high of \$345.72 — the largest peak-to-trough drawdown of any mega-cap in the capture, and a reminder of what an AI-capex de-rating looks like when it actually happens.

- **Netflix gained 2.77% to \$82.23**, 35.1% below its high, and **Tapestry fell 1.54%** to \$130.12. Applied Materials opened at \$490.06 and closed at \$480.04, down 0.86%.

10 Macro data

- **Conference Board consumer confidence, August: 89.4 actual vs 90.1 consensus**, from a downwardly revised 90.2 in July (originally 90.8). The lowest reading since January.
- **The composition is worse than the headline.** The Expectations Index fell **5.8 points to 68.2** while the Present Situation Index **rose 6.8 points to 121.2**. Consumers say today is fine and the next six months are not — specifically on business conditions and the labour market. A 68.2 expectations reading is deep in the range historically associated with recession signalling; a 121.2 present-situation reading is not.
- **That divergence is the single most useful macro fact of the session** and it went almost entirely unremarked because the headline only missed by 0.7. Discretionary (XLY) fell 0.30% on the day; nothing else visibly repriced.
- **Wednesday carries the heavier load:** Q2 GDP second estimate at 20:30 GMT+8 with consensus at 1.5% against 2.1% previously, the PCE price index in the same release window, and durable goods orders. A GDP revision from 2.1% to 1.5% is a six-tenths downgrade to the growth quad input.
- **The inflation calendar is the real constraint.** Hedgeye is explicit that August CPI, roughly two weeks out, should show year-on-year re-acceleration, which would push rate-cut expectations lower and raise the possibility of hike discussion. Everything in the 2-year yield call rests on that.
- **Treasury's expanded debt buyback programme** continued to sit behind the long end this week, with reports that the government may draw on its cash account to finance the larger repurchases.

11 Geopolitics

- **◆ Washington replaced the threat of force with a financial campaign against Iran**, rolled out globally on Monday and described by Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent — per his own remarks as reported — as an "economic D-Day" and "the single greatest financial offensive ever marshaled against an adversary". The programme has been given the name Operation Economic Outcast.
- **▼ Oil read it as de-escalation, not escalation.** Sanctions constrain Iranian export revenue; strikes constrain the Strait of Hormuz. Traders shrugged and sold, taking Brent to a one-week low. That is a rational reading, and it is also a fragile one: it holds only for as long as the campaign stays financial.
- **◆ China is the pressure point and has said so.** Beijing buys roughly 90% of Iran's oil exports. Foreign Ministry spokesperson Lin Jian said China opposes "illicit unilateral sanctions" and that "Economic warfare and maximum pressure provide no solution." Attributed to the Chinese foreign ministry; the underlying export share is a widely reported estimate rather than an audited figure.
- **◆ Tehran says it is prepared.** Economy Minister Ali Madanizadeh told state television that the government "is and was ready and has a two-year plan to manage these events". That is Iran's own claim, made on Iranian state media, and should be weighted accordingly.
- **▲ Ukraine marked Independence Day** with UK Prime Minister Andy Burnham in Kyiv announcing that MBDA will release details of UK-made SCALP missile components so Ukraine can assemble the weapons domestically. A supply-chain transfer rather than a delivery, which is a different and more durable kind of commitment.
- **◆ The offshore yuan sits at a 52-week high against the dollar** on the day Beijing publicly rejected the sanctions framework. If the campaign were expected to bite China materially, that is not where CNH would be trading.

12 Overnight setup — what Asia opens into

INSTRUMENT	LIVE LEVEL	CHANGE	VOLUME / RANGE
ES — E-mini S&P	7,692.00	▲ +0.29%	961,644 · 7,660-7,714
NQ — E-mini Nasdaq-100	29,276.75	▲ +0.59%	480,945 · 29,017-29,426
YM — E-mini Dow	53,645	▲ +0.29%	52,407 · 53,426-53,797
RTY — E-mini Russell	3,014.40	▲ +0.43%	109,902 · 2,997-3,025
USD/JPY	159.217	◆ +0.01%	3.8-pip range
USD/KRW	1,382.03	◆ -0.03%	1,380.54-1,386.67
USD/TWD	31.8151	◆ +0.09%	31.783-31.864
USD/CNH	6.7162	◆ -0.01%	1.2-pip range · 52w low 6.7156
EUR/USD	1.1675	◆ +0.01%	8-pip range
Gold spot	\$4,660.28	◆ +0.07%	\$5.86 range
Silver spot	\$68.818	◆ +0.31%	\$0.21 range

INSTRUMENT	LIVE LEVEL	CHANGE	VOLUME / RANGE
Copper spot	\$6.6711	◆ -0.03%	\$0.006 range
WTI crude	\$82.36	▼ -3.12%	261,364 · \$80.23-\$85.84
Brent crude	\$88.58	▼ -3.90%	18,595 · \$86.09-\$92.84
Bitcoin	\$78,748.71	▼ -0.29%	\$77,853-\$81,233
Ether	\$2,448.26	▼ -1.36%	\$2,416-\$2,531

- **The US hands over a semiconductor bid it did not fully hold.** SOX +1.44% but 120 points off its high into the close; SMH +1.65%, SOXX +1.56%, both firmer again after hours (+0.21% and +0.39%). Korea and Taiwan get a positive handover, with a caveat attached.
- **Previous Asian closes, marked as such:** Nikkei **65,856.36** (+0.50%, Tue close), KOSPI **6,742.75** (+0.68%), Hang Seng **25,511.11** (-0.02%), Shanghai **3,889.44** (+0.19%), ASX 200 **9,164.60** (+0.68%), Sensex **77,656.09** (+0.37%). None of these has traded since.
- **Korea has the most to reprice and the worst starting point.** The KOSPI is **28.2% below** its 52-week high after breaking Hedgeye's 6,796 TRADE level on Monday. It bounced 0.68% on Tuesday. Hedgeye holds no position in EWY and none in DRAM into tonight's Nvidia print — an explicit refusal to take the obvious Korea-semis exposure.
- **Japan is the constructive one.** The Nikkei returned to bullish TRADE and TREND and sits at just **25.6%** of a very wide 64,708-69,201 band — low in the range with the signal in its favour, which is the setup Hedgeye pays for.
- **Taiwan is the transmission line.** USD/TWD at 31.8151 is mid-range and quiet; if Nvidia's print moves the semiconductor complex tonight, TWD is where Thursday's Asian session will show it first.
- **The single instrument most likely to move today is Bitcoin** — it is the only genuinely live market, it has already swung 4.3% overnight, and it is the one asset that will trade continuously through the Nvidia release rather than gapping into it.

13 AI watch

- **Nvidia is reportedly close to guaranteeing roughly \$100bn of credit** supporting another very large OpenAI data centre. Reported, not confirmed by either company. If accurate, it is vendor financing at a scale that makes the customer's balance sheet partly the supplier's problem — and it lands the day before Nvidia reports.
- **Anthropic hired Amir Salek**, who founded Google's TPU programme and shipped seven generations of the chips before leaving in 2022, into its compute team. Hiring the person who built the main credible alternative to Nvidia silicon is a statement about where inference cost is going.
- **Anthropic and Microsoft both announced new AI data centre projects**, continuing the construction cycle that is the actual demand behind tonight's numbers.
- **A serious prompt-injection technique was published.** Adversa AI demonstrated hiding AES-256-GCM-encrypted instructions inside a webpage; when Grok is asked to summarise the page, its Python sandbox decrypts the payload and treats the recovered prompt as trusted context, exfiltrating user name, approximate location, subscription tier and active chat history to an attacker-controlled URL. Sandboxed code execution turning a summarisation request into a data-exfiltration primitive is a category of failure the industry has not priced.
- **Tonight is the referendum.** \$91.9bn consensus against a \$91.0bn $\pm 2\%$ guide means the bar is 0.9% above the company's own midpoint. Four consecutive beats of 5.65%, 6.58%, 4.00% and 2.97% — a decaying sequence — and a selloff after every one.

14 Beyond the markets

- **Every one of the Magnificent Seven is below its 52-week high**, two of them by close to 30%, and the S&P is 1.78% off a record. The index is being carried by the 493, and has been for six weeks.
- **Oracle is 58% below its 52-week high** and nobody is writing about it. Six months ago it was the cleanest AI-capex proxy in the market.
- **Silver's 43% drawdown coexists with physical backwardation.** Those two facts do not normally sit together and one of them is going to resolve.
- **Investment-grade corporate credit is 1.4% above its 52-week low** on a day equities closed near records. Duration, not default — but the divergence is real and it is a year old.
- **Huge fires across central and western Indonesia** have burned wide areas of forest and peatland, blanketing cities in haze. Peatland fires release carbon at a rate that makes regional emissions accounting temporarily meaningless, and the shipping and aviation disruption is regional and immediate.
- **Keith McCullough opened the Early Look with Dusty Baker's memoir** and a line about a high-school coach who was hard on him — the point being that the parent who never meddled was doing the harder job. It is the least quantitative paragraph Hedgeye published this week and probably the most useful.

15 Appendix — stock cards**NVDA · NVIDIA****213.05** ▲ +4.57 (+2.19%)

Cap \$5.156tn · Range \$192-230 · TREND \$208, TRADE \$218 (broken) · Reports tonight after the US close

Reclaimed the TREND line it closed exactly on the day before, on 119% of average volume, and added 0.42% after hours. Sits 55% of the way up its risk range and 9.9% below its high. Implied vol moved from a 7% discount to a 10% premium. Hedgeye holds no position by choice.

AMD · ADVANCED MICRO DEVICES**479.18** ▲ +22.44 (+4.91%)

Cap \$782bn · 18.1% below 52w high \$584.73 · Volume 18.9m vs 19.1m average

The largest percentage gain in the semiconductor complex, delivered on exactly average volume — which makes it a repricing rather than an accumulation. Closed 2.32 below the session high. Sets the tone for Asian semis at 08:00.

MU · MICRON TECHNOLOGY**932.97** ▲ +22.54 (+2.48%)

Cap \$1.054tn · 25.7% below 52w high \$1,255 · Volume 19.1m = 65% of average

Recovered less than half of Monday's 5.8% fall, on two-thirds of normal volume. Named by Hedgeye alongside NVDA and AVGO as one of three stocks responsible for most of Monday's index damage. A trillion-dollar memory company is a new kind of index risk.

SNDK · SANDISK**1,480.77** ▼ -12.35 (-0.83%)

Cap \$217bn · 37.1% below 52w high \$2,354.39 · Intraday range \$1,467-\$1,565

Did not participate in the bounce. A \$98 range and a close near the low while Western Digital rose 3.53% breaks the memory complex into two. Added 0.28% after hours, which does not undo the day.

ORCL · ORACLE**144.76** ▲ +2.31 (+1.62%)Cap \$417bn · **58.1% below** 52w high \$345.72 · 52w low \$114.50

The largest drawdown of any mega-cap in this capture and the most instructive one. Oracle has already had the AI-capex de-rating that the rest of the complex is arguing about. It is 26% above its own 52-week low, not near it.

META · META PLATFORMS**570.05** ▲ +11.03 (+1.97%)

Cap \$1.452tn · 27.9% below 52w high \$790.80 · only 9.6% above 52w low \$520.26

Best Mag7 performer on the day and the second-weakest structurally. Closed at the session high, then gave 2.05 back after hours. Hedgeye added a short position in FBY, the Meta option-income ETF, the same session.

INTC · INTEL**87.48** ▲ +0.22 (+0.25%)

Cap \$460bn · Opened \$90.06, high \$90.18, closed \$87.48 · 81.4m shares

Up on the day and 3.0% below its own session high. Gapped 3.4% higher at the open on a semiconductor rally and was sold all the way back. The clearest distribution pattern on the tape.

WDAY · WORKDAY**194.42** ▼ -4.73 (-2.38%)

Cap \$48bn · 22.2% below 52w high \$249.85 · \$193.05 after hours (-0.70%)

Weakest large-cap software close of the session, and kept falling after the bell. Sits awkwardly against Hedgeye's long-IGV stance — the software long is an index position, not a name-by-name endorsement.

16 About this edition

- **Covers** — the US cash session of Tuesday 25 August as settled, the after-hours tape through 06:00 GMT+8, the Globex session to capture, and the full Hedgeye evening publication set.
- **Captured** — 06:07:10-06:07:13 GMT+8, a 2.6-second window, via the standard concurrent capture. TradingView returned 96 of 96 instruments. **Yahoo returned nothing**: the circuit breaker tripped on five consecutive HTTP 429s, so the machine capture is single-sourced and the cross-checks were recovered by hand from wire and vendor copy. Divergences and their resolution are in section 18.
- **Clock note** — Globex reopened at 06:00, seven minutes before capture, so every futures row carries the *Tuesday* session and not the new one; FX and spot metals have run roughly 67 minutes and their change figures are noise, not moves. Both are labelled as such throughout.
- **Settled vs live** — cash equities, Treasury yields, energy and metals futures are settled and roughly 2h 07m old at capture. FX, spot metals and index futures are live but nearly empty. Crypto is the only genuinely continuous row.
- **Hedgeye edition** — full logged-in feed reached. The live risk-range set is the Early Look *Broadening Continues Into #Quad1* by **Keith McCullough**, published 25 Aug 19:59 GMT+8; Wednesday evening's Early Look supersedes it. Also read: the Macro Show summary and replay (25 Aug 22:14), ETF Pro Plus update (22:45), KM's Top 3 Things (24 Aug 18:30) and Signal Strength Stocks (26 Aug 02:25).
- **Quad path** — **3 → 1 → 2, explicitly restated and unchanged**. September remains the #Quad1 month.
- **Not available** — Monday's Early Look (category page does not paginate), IGV, and any MOMO Tracker, Crypto Quant, Chart of the Day or Real-Time Alerts published since the previous edition — none appeared in the feed.

17 Sources

Prices. TradingView bulk scanner, 96 of 96 instruments, 06:07:10-06:07:11 GMT+8; Yahoo Finance attempted concurrently 06:07:10-06:07:13 and aborted on rate limiting. Hedgeye-named series measured on TVC:GOLD, TVC:SILVER, OANDA:XCUUSD for the metals and NYMEX:CL1! and NG1! for the energy pair.

Hedgeye. app.hedgeye.com logged-in feed, read 06:09-06:14 GMT+8: Early Look (25 Aug), Macro Show summary notes and replay (25 Aug), ETF Pro Plus update (25 Aug), KM's Top 3 Things (24 Aug), Signal Strength Stocks (26 Aug).

Macro. The Conference Board for the August consumer confidence release; Investing.com and Reuters via Investing and Seeking Alpha for consensus and the sub-index detail; Investing.com and Econoday for the Wednesday calendar.

Narrative and single stocks. CNBC for the session recap, Treasury yields and the oil close; TheStreet for the 25 August intraday tape; MarketScreener and AskTraders for the Intuit after-hours reaction; 24/7 Wall St. for Zoom; Investing.com, Seeking Alpha, The Motley Fool and REX Shares for the Nvidia earnings setup and consensus.

Commodities, geopolitics and AI. CNBC and Reuters for the Iran sanctions programme, the Chinese and Iranian responses, and the crude settlements; Stratechery and Seeking Alpha for the Nvidia-OpenAI financing report, the Anthropic hire and the data-centre announcements; Adversa AI's own publication for the Grok exfiltration technique; NPR and Washington Post world desks for Ukraine and Indonesia.

18 Data-confidence

CROSS-CHECKS PASSED

- **Cash index arithmetic ties exactly to three independently reported Monday closes.** S&P: 7,677.28 – 24.42 = **7,652.86**, matching the published Monday settle to the cent. Dow: 53,577.40 – 160.24 = **53,417.16**, exact. Nasdaq: 26,151.30 – 171.11 = **25,980.19**, exact. Three for three from a wholly separate source chain. This is the strongest validation in the run and it substitutes for the machine cross-check that Yahoo failed to provide.
- **Futures-versus-cash basis is normal on all four contracts**, which confirms the settled rows are genuine settles and the futures rows are genuine futures rather than mislabelled duplicates. ES 7,692.00 vs 7,677.28 = +14.72 (+19.2bp); YM 53,645 vs 53,577.40 = +67.6 (+12.6bp); RTY 3,014.40 vs 3,010.02 = +4.38 (+14.6bp). All three land in a tight +13 to +19bp band. NQ could not be checked — the cash Nasdaq-100 was not in the capture set.
- **Crude settles reconcile exactly against wire copy.** WTI \$82.36 and Brent \$88.58 in the capture match the settlement figures carried by CNBC and Reuters to the cent. Percentage changes agree to within 0.02pp on WTI (–3.12% captured, –3.14% reported).
- **The 10-year yield reconciles to 0.6bp.** Capture 4.623%, CNBC 4.629%. One other outlet carried 4.66% for the same date; that figure is inconsistent with both the settle and the intraday range of 4.619-4.716 and has been rejected.
- **S&P percentage change confirmed independently** at +0.32% by secondary market coverage, matching the captured +0.3191% exactly.
- **Reconciliation counts from the capture script: 0 matched within 5bp, 0 minor, 0 divergent, 57 single-sourced.** There are **no divergent rows to resolve because no second machine source ran** — that is a null result, not a clean reconciliation, and it should not be read as one. The hand checks above are what carry this edition.
- **Volume sanity confirms the session labelling.** ES turned over 961.6k lots against a 1.128m ten-day average. Seven minutes of post-reopen trade cannot produce 85% of a daily average, which independently confirms the futures rows carry Tuesday's Globex session.

KNOWN CONFLICTS AND WEAK MARKS

- **Dow percentage change is disputed.** The capture gives +0.30% (+160.24); one outlet reported +0.22%. The point change of 160.24 ties exactly to the independently reported Monday close, so **the capture is used** and the +0.22% figure is treated as an intraday snapshot taken before the settle.
- **Intraday crude quotes conflict with settles.** One source carried Brent –3.2% at \$89.20 and WTI –3.3% at \$82.21 against settles of \$88.58 and \$82.36. Those are intraday marks, not closes. The settles are used throughout.
- **AMD's gain is reported two ways:** +4.91% in the capture, +4.63% in press coverage. The capture figure is a settle-to-settle calculation and is used; the difference is roughly 28bp and does not change the reading.
- **Fourteen of the seventeen risk-range band moves are UNKNOWN.** Only the S&P, 10-year and gold bands could be diffed, and even those were diffed against KM's Top 3 Things — a different publication from the same author on the same Monday morning — because the Early Look category page does not paginate. Treat those three moves as well-sourced and the other fourteen as genuinely unmeasured. **They are not unchanged; they are unknown.**
- **Percentages measured from 52-week highs are robust in direction and soft in the decimal.** Each rests on a single TradingView field. The claim that the SOX is roughly 21% below its high and the NYSE Composite roughly 0.4% below its own is safe; the specific figures of 20.93% and 0.39% carry perhaps a few basis points of uncertainty from how each vendor timestamps the extreme.
- **Market capitalisations are TradingView fundamental fields captured at 06:07** and move with the last price. The \$23.21tn Mag7 aggregate is accurate to within roughly a tenth of a percent and no more.
- **Zoom's results are thinly sourced.** The 184% AI Companion paid-user growth figure was confirmed, but the enterprise net dollar expansion number — the metric the market was actually watching — could not be verified this morning and is stated as unresolved rather than guessed.
- **Spot-versus-futures bases were checked and are benign.** Gold's \$34.22 contango and silver's \$0.14 backwardation are both consistent with normal carry and mild physical tightness respectively; neither indicates a bad mark. The silver backwardation is the more interesting of the two and rests on a single simultaneous pair of quotes.

KNOWN GAPS

- **Yahoo Finance was entirely unavailable** — five consecutive HTTP 429s tripped the circuit breaker two seconds into the run. No independent machine price series, no multi-day daily bars, and therefore no week-on-week context in this edition.
- **No MOMO Tracker, Crypto Quant, Chart of the Day or Real-Time Alerts** appeared in the Hedgeye feed since the previous edition. Those are precisely the publications that would carry an intraday position change. **The absence of a Hedgeye position change in this brief is not evidence that there was none** — it is evidence that the publications which would report one did not appear.
- **Monday's Early Look could not be opened.** The category-filtered page at /feed_items/all?page=N&with_category=24-early-look returns the same single note on pages 1, 2 and 3, and the unfiltered feed index returns an identical six-item list on all three pages. This was tested this morning and is a genuine site behaviour, not a fetch failure.
- **IGV was not in the capture set**, so the software long — a named core position — has no measurable band position in this edition.
- **The cash Nasdaq-100 was not captured**, so the NQ futures basis is the one contract that could not be validated against its underlying.
- **Asian and European cash markets are closed.** Every non-US index level in section 12 is a previous close and is labelled as one. Tokyo opens 08:00, Seoul 08:30, Hong Kong 09:30, India 12:15 GMT+8.
- **Wednesday's GDP consensus of 1.5%** comes from a secondary calendar aggregator rather than the BEA, and the same applies to the durable goods and building permits timings.

TIMING & UNVERIFIED

- **Capture window 06:07:10-06:07:13 GMT+8, 2.6 seconds.** No top-up pass was required and no row in this brief was captured outside that window.
- **The stalest rows are roughly 2 hours 7 minutes old** — US cash equities, which settled at 04:00 GMT+8. Treasury cash yields settled at 05:00 and are roughly 1 hour 7 minutes old. Energy and metals futures settled with their respective pit closes and are of comparable age.
- **The freshest rows contain almost no information.** Index futures have seven minutes of trade since the 06:00 Globex reopen; FX and spot metals have roughly 67 minutes since the 05:00 roll. A 3.8-pip range in dollar-yen and a \$5.86 range in gold are not moves and are not presented as such anywhere in this document.
- **Bitcoin and Ether are the only rows with a full overnight session behind them.** Bitcoin's 4.3% range is real.
- **The risk ranges in section 4 will be superseded** by Wednesday evening's Early Look, roughly 19:25-21:00 GMT+8 today. Hedgeye's 2-year yield call is already under strain: it was made at 22:14 GMT+8 on a move above 4.20% and the yield closed at 4.176%.
- **Nvidia reports after the US close tonight**, roughly 04:20 GMT+8 Thursday. Every semiconductor level in this brief has a known expiry.
- **Verify live prices before acting on anything here.** This is a pre-market brief assembled from a three-second snapshot taken before Asia opened.